

2025 HSC English Standard — Paper 1

Marking Guidelines

Section I

Question 1

Criteria	Marks
• Explains effectively how Pippas portrays Lucky's sense of hope for the future, using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
• Explains how Pippas portrays Lucky's sense of hope for the future, using appropriate supporting evidence	3
• Describes how Pippas portrays Lucky's sense of hope for the future, using some supporting evidence	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Pippas portrays Lucky's hope for the future through the metaphor of the ship as a 'diorama of the world', showing that Lucky feels like the whole world is open to him. Lucky imagines Valia at various times of day, 'working or eating', or 'flicking up to distance a fly', and Pippas states that for Lucky these are 'pleasing scenarios'. Lucky has 'two gold rings hidden' which are symbolic of the love and promise of marriage and hope he feels for his future with Valia in Australia. Pippas describes Circular Quay as 'heavy with activity' and the 'northern shore in repose', the contrast between action and peace reflecting Lucky's hope for his future success in both his business and his peaceful home with Valia.

Question 2

Criteria	Marks
Explains in a highly effective manner how Fidge explores the impact of role models in her childhood, using detailed, well-chosen supporting evidence	5
Explains effectively how Fidge explores the impact of role models in her childhood, using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Explains how Fidge explores the impact of role models in her childhood, with appropriate supporting evidence	3
Describes the impact of role models in her childhood	2
Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Fidge explores the ‘monumental’ impact that her favourite superhero, She-Ra, had in childhood through a strong, personal voice. She states that ‘She-Ra was *made* for me and my sister’, demonstrating the importance of diverse gender representation of role models. When describing that they were ‘desperate to see... women doing anything remotely interesting’, Fidge uses humour to emphasise the importance of seeing role models on television in childhood that resonated with her desire to see ‘strong women’ being represented doing aspirational things. When She-Ra was taken off the air, Fidge and her sister protested by writing ‘letters to the station to express our disappointment’. Her letter is a small act of protest where she exclaims, ‘*Put back She-Ra. Do it... NOW!!*’ where the imperative voice demonstrates the impact of having a superhero role model as it gave the author ongoing confidence to communicate her opinion with the hope of making change.

Question 3

Criteria	Marks
Explains effectively how Jansson celebrates the process of creativity, using appropriate supporting evidence	3
Explains how Jansson celebrates the process of creativity, using some supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Jansson celebrates the process of creativity, firstly through an appreciation of physical materials, ‘pretty rocks’ and ‘beautiful, heavy lumber’ as the raw materials of future projects. Jansson lists a range of unusual stone creations: ‘mosaics, bulwarks, terraces, supports, smoke ovens’, delighting in their variety ranging from decorative, useful or temporary, ‘which the sea will carry away’. This ultimately shows how Jansson privileges the creative process over the product. By contrasting Tooti’s creations in wood, ‘the smallest salt spoon ever made’ with ‘building big’, Jansson celebrates that creativity comes in different forms and sizes.

Question 4

Criteria	Marks
• Explains effectively how Ferrante portrays the ways that family relationships shape identity, using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
• Explains how Ferrante portrays the ways that family relationships shape identity, using appropriate supporting evidence	3
• Describes how Ferrante portrays the ways that family relationships shape identity, with some supporting evidence	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Ferrante portrays contrasting relationships with different parts of the narrator's family, leading to shifts in her identity. Her identity is initially significantly influenced by her father's views, exemplified in the blunt and critical tone of 'deprived me of the affection of people certainly without education, not smooth talkers', emphasising her physical separation from lower classes of people, including her own extended family. This belief is challenged when Giovanna meets her relative, Vittoria, who teaches her the importance of 'the heart' which symbolises a person's character as the most essential element of identity. This experience causes a deeper understanding of herself seen through the metaphorical shift from the formal 'Giovanna' to the affectionate nickname Giannina, which signifies her new 'relaxed and funny' identity.

Question 5

Criteria	Marks
• Analyses how Kooser shares insights about the experience of change, using well-chosen support evidence	4
• Analyses how Kooser shares insights about the experience of change, using appropriate supporting evidence	3
• Explains how Kooser shares insights about the experience of change, with some supporting evidence	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Kooser frames the poem in letter form to signal that he wishes to share his experiences regarding the inevitability of change. The personification of the light to 'walk down the hill' enables him to share his delight in how the lake lights up to reveal 'a garden/of trees that grew as if by magic'. In contrast the personification of 'winter' in its 'jacket', bringing its 'black horse', depicts winter bringing darkness. He metaphorically compares summer's light, which allows one to 'keep looking out' with winter's darkness which offers only a mirror that forces introspection. The imperative 'must' captures his final insight where one 'must now keep looking in' to examine how the passage of time requires change.

Section II

Question 6

Criteria	Marks
- Analyses skilfully how the representation of particular lives in their prescribed text enriches their understanding of the endurance of the human spirit - Presents a perceptive response supported by well-chosen textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a coherent and sustained response using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context	17–20
- Analyses effectively how the representation of particular lives in their prescribed text enriches their understanding of the endurance of the human spirit - Presents a thoughtful response supported by relevant textual references from the prescribed text - Writes an organised response using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context	13–16
- Explains how the representation of particular lives in their prescribed text enriches their understanding of the endurance of the human spirit - Presents a response supported by some textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a response using variable control of language appropriate to audience, purpose and context	9–12
- Expresses limited understanding of how the representation of particular lives in their prescribed text enriches their understanding of the human spirit - Describes aspects of the prescribed text - Writes a response with limited control of language	5–8
- Refers to the prescribed text in a minimal way - Attempts to compose a response	1–4

2025 HSC English Standard — Paper 1 Mapping Grid

Section I

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
1	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3
2	5	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3, EN12-5
3	3	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3
4	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3,
5	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3, EN12-5

Section II

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
6	20	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences – Prose Fiction – Poetry – Drama – Nonfiction – Film – Media	EN12-1, EN12-3, EN12-5, EN12-7